

CASE STUDY ON

“TRAITS OF AN ENTREPRENEUR”

LLO 2.1: Identify different traits as an entrepreneur from various fields

LLO 2.2: Suggest different traits from identified problem

Case Study: Azim Premji – Founder of Wipro

1. Introduction

Azim Premji is an Indian entrepreneur and philanthropist who transformed Wipro from a company primarily involved in consumer products into a major information technology services company. He took responsibility for the family business at a young age and later guided its diversification and growth in the technology sector.

His entrepreneurial journey is a useful example for understanding traits such as opportunity recognition, risk-taking, innovation, leadership, persistence, decision-making, adaptability, and social responsibility.

2. Entrepreneur Profile

Particular	Details
Name	Azim Premji
Business	Wipro
Industry	Information Technology & Services
Role	Founder / Entrepreneur and former Chairman
Major Idea	Transforming and expanding the business into technology and IT services
Field	Technology / Business

3. Problem Identified

When Azim Premji took over the family business, the company operated mainly in the consumer products sector. The business needed to respond to changing market conditions and identify new areas for long-term growth. As technology began creating new business opportunities, Premji recognized the potential of the information technology sector.

He identified diversification into technology as an opportunity to build a more competitive and future-oriented business.

4. Business Idea / Solution

Azim Premji led Wipro's transformation and diversification into the information technology industry. The company gradually developed capabilities in software and IT services and expanded its presence in the global technology market.

This transformation required investment in technology, development of skilled employees, new business strategies, and adaptation to changing customer and industry requirements.

5. Entrepreneurial Traits Identified

Trait 1: Opportunity Recognition

Azim Premji recognized the long-term potential of information technology and guided Wipro toward a new industry. He identified an opportunity beyond the company's traditional business activities.

Entrepreneurial lesson: An entrepreneur should be able to identify emerging opportunities and prepare the business for future growth.

Trait 2: Risk-Taking

Moving from a traditional consumer-products business toward technology involved uncertainty and required significant strategic commitment. Premji accepted this challenge and supported Wipro's transformation.

Entrepreneurial lesson: Entrepreneurs should be willing to take calculated risks when pursuing promising opportunities.

Trait 3: Innovation

Wipro's growth in technology required new capabilities, processes, products, and services. Premji encouraged the organization to develop and compete in a technology-driven environment.

Entrepreneurial lesson: Innovation helps an entrepreneur create new capabilities and respond to changing markets.

Trait 4: Persistence

Transforming an established company into a technology-focused organization required sustained effort over many years. Premji continued to develop Wipro despite the challenges of changing industries and global competition.

Entrepreneurial lesson: Persistence helps entrepreneurs remain committed to long-term goals despite obstacles.

Trait 5: Leadership

As the leader of Wipro, Premji played an important role in setting direction, building organizational capabilities, and guiding employees through major changes.

Entrepreneurial lesson: Leadership enables entrepreneurs to communicate a vision and guide people toward common goals.

Trait 6: Decision-Making

Wipro's transformation involved important decisions regarding diversification, technology, talent, investment, services, and global expansion. Premji had to make strategic decisions in an uncertain environment.

Entrepreneurial lesson: Effective decision-making helps entrepreneurs manage uncertainty and use resources wisely.

Trait 7: Adaptability

The technology industry changes rapidly. Wipro had to adapt its services, capabilities, and strategies to changing technology and customer requirements.

Entrepreneurial lesson: Entrepreneurs must be flexible and willing to change their strategies as markets evolve.

Trait 8: Social Responsibility

Azim Premji is also widely associated with philanthropy and the use of business success to support education and social development through the Azim Premji Foundation.

Entrepreneurial lesson: Successful entrepreneurs can use their resources and influence to create positive social impact.

6. Challenges Faced

- Managing the transformation from a traditional business into a technology-focused organization.
- Entering and competing in the rapidly developing IT industry.
- Building skilled human resources and technological capabilities.
- Adapting to changing technology and customer requirements.
- Competing with established global technology companies.
- Managing long-term business growth and diversification.
- Making strategic decisions under changing market conditions.

7. Key Entrepreneurial Traits

Opportunity Recognition → Risk-Taking → Innovation → Persistence → Leadership → Decision-Making → Adaptability → Social Responsibility

These traits demonstrate how Azim Premji identified an emerging opportunity, transformed an established business, developed new capabilities, led organizational change, and adapted to the evolving technology industry while also emphasizing social impact.

8. Conclusion

The case of Azim Premji demonstrates that entrepreneurship is not only about starting a new business. An entrepreneur must be able to identify opportunities, take calculated risks, innovate, make strategic decisions, lead people, persist through challenges, and adapt to changing business environments.

Azim Premji's journey with Wipro shows how an entrepreneur can transform an established business by recognizing future opportunities and developing the capabilities needed to compete in a new industry. His work also highlights the importance of social responsibility, demonstrating how entrepreneurial success can be connected with broader social impact.